2.8 Importance of water

Human body: Our body uses water in all its cells, organs and tissues to help regulate its temperature and maintain other bodily functions. On an average, the human body requires 2 – 3 litres of water per day for proper functioning. Water helps in digestion of food and removal of toxins from the body.

Domestic: Apart from drinking, people use water for many other purposes. These include: cooking, bathing, washing clothes, washing utensils, keeping houses and common places clean, watering plants, etc.



Swamps are wetlands that are forested. They occur along large rivers or on the shores of large lakes. The water of a swamp may be freshwater, brackish water or seawater. Swamps are important for providing fresh water and oxygen to all life. Pichavaram Mangroves in Chidambaram, Muthupet mangrove wetland. Pallikkaranai wetland in Chennai, Chembarambakkam in Kancheepuram are a few examples of swamps in Tamilnadu.



Agriculture: Water is also essential for the healthy growth of farm crops and farm stock and is used in the manufacture of many products.

Industry: Industry depends on water at all levels of production. It is used as a material, a solvent and for generating electricity.

Activity 6: Estimation of water consumed by a family on a day

Activity	Amount of water used (in litres)
Brushing	
Bathing	
Washing clothes	
Toilets	
Cooking	
Washing utensils	
Cleaning floor	
Any other purpose	
Total amount of water used by a family in a day	

2.9 Water distribution and treatment system

We know that water is distributed by local bodies. In some areas which water is obtained from river, lake and ground water is treated and distributed. Model of water distribution and treatment plant is shown in figures.

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